NOTES FROM THE KITCHEN

TEMPERATURES & DONENESS

Every oven, grill, and pot of oil in this book carries both Fahrenheit and Celsius—so the recipes travel as easily as the dishes themselves.

When a cut of meat needs a particular internal temperature, an instant-read thermometer is the surest path; color and time will only take you so far. The marks these recipes lean on most are gathered here.

What you're cooking	Aim for
Deep- or shallow-frying	350–375°F (175–190°C)
Beef, medium-rare	130°F (54°C)
Beef, medium	140–145°F (60–63°C)
Ground meats & burgers	160°F (71°C)
Poultry, cooked through	165°F (74°C)
Fish, flaky and just done	145°F (63°C)
A low, slow roast (prime rib)	200°F (93°C) oven, then seared hot
Most baking in this book	350–400°F (175–204°C)

Doneness is a matter of taste as much as safety—pull meat a few degrees early and let it rest, and it will climb to just where you want it.

Now—to the hearth. Let's begin.

OUR CULINARY MAP

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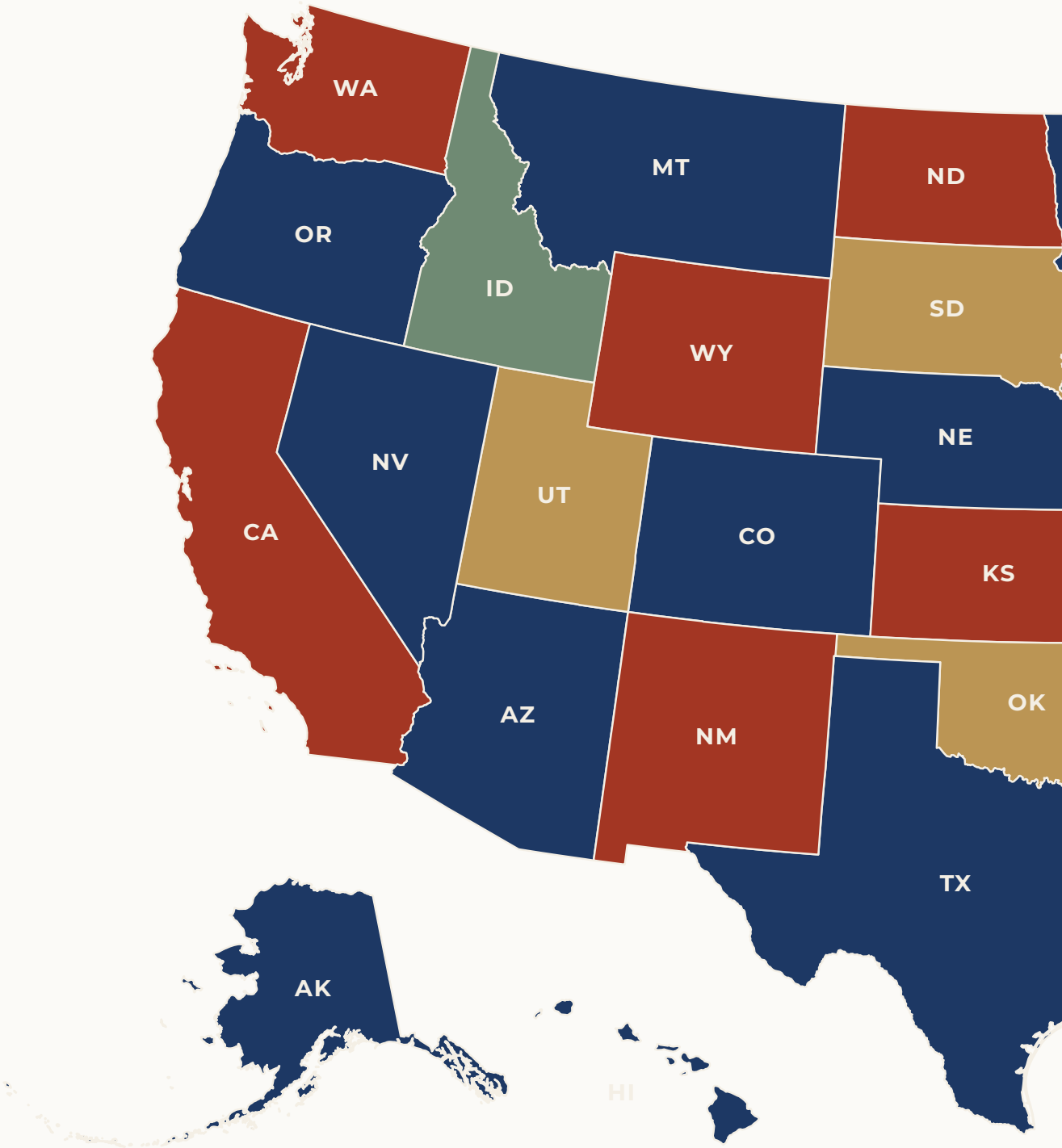
A look at the fifty stops on this table-spanning journey, from coastline to farmland to mountain pass.

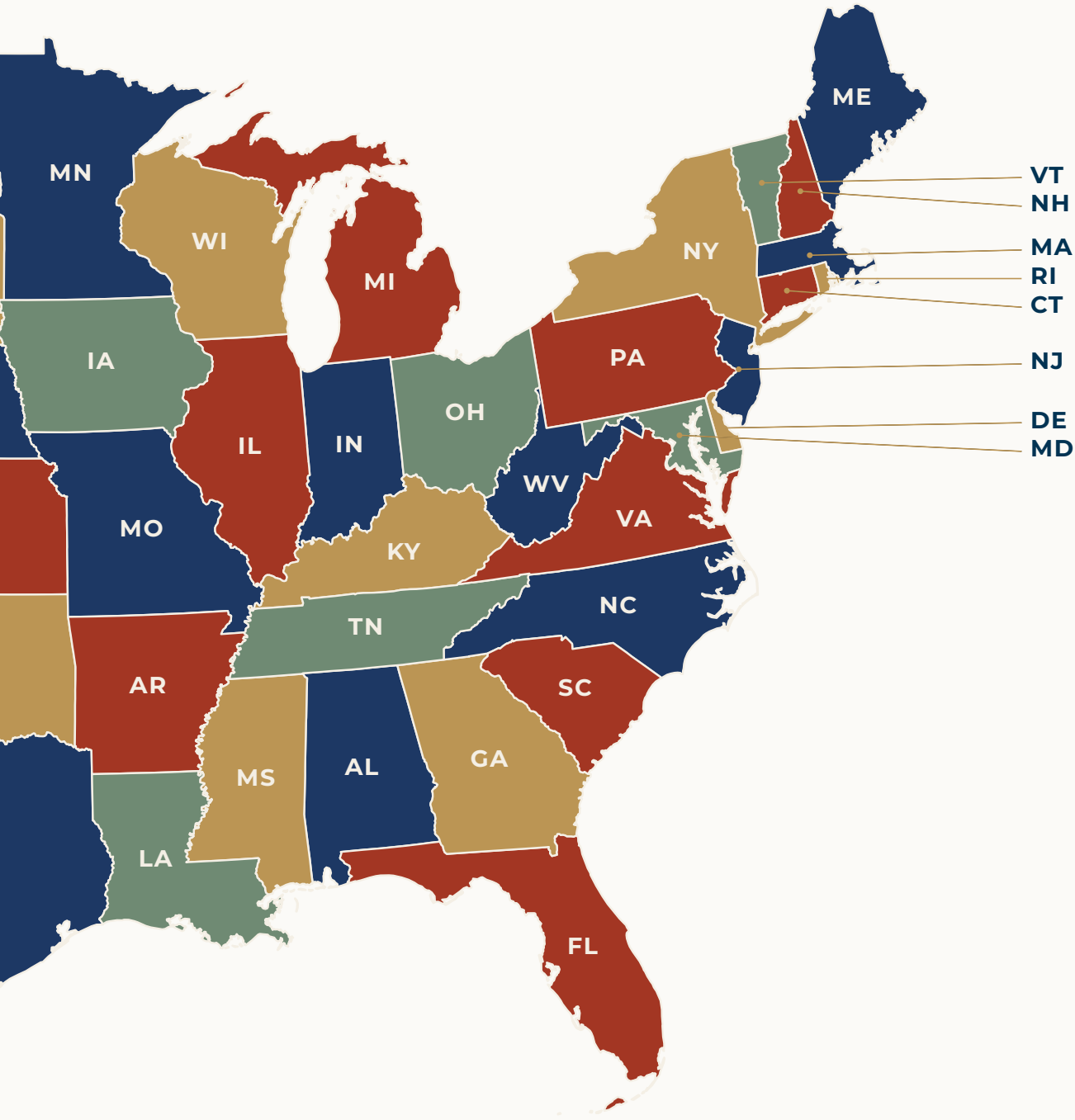



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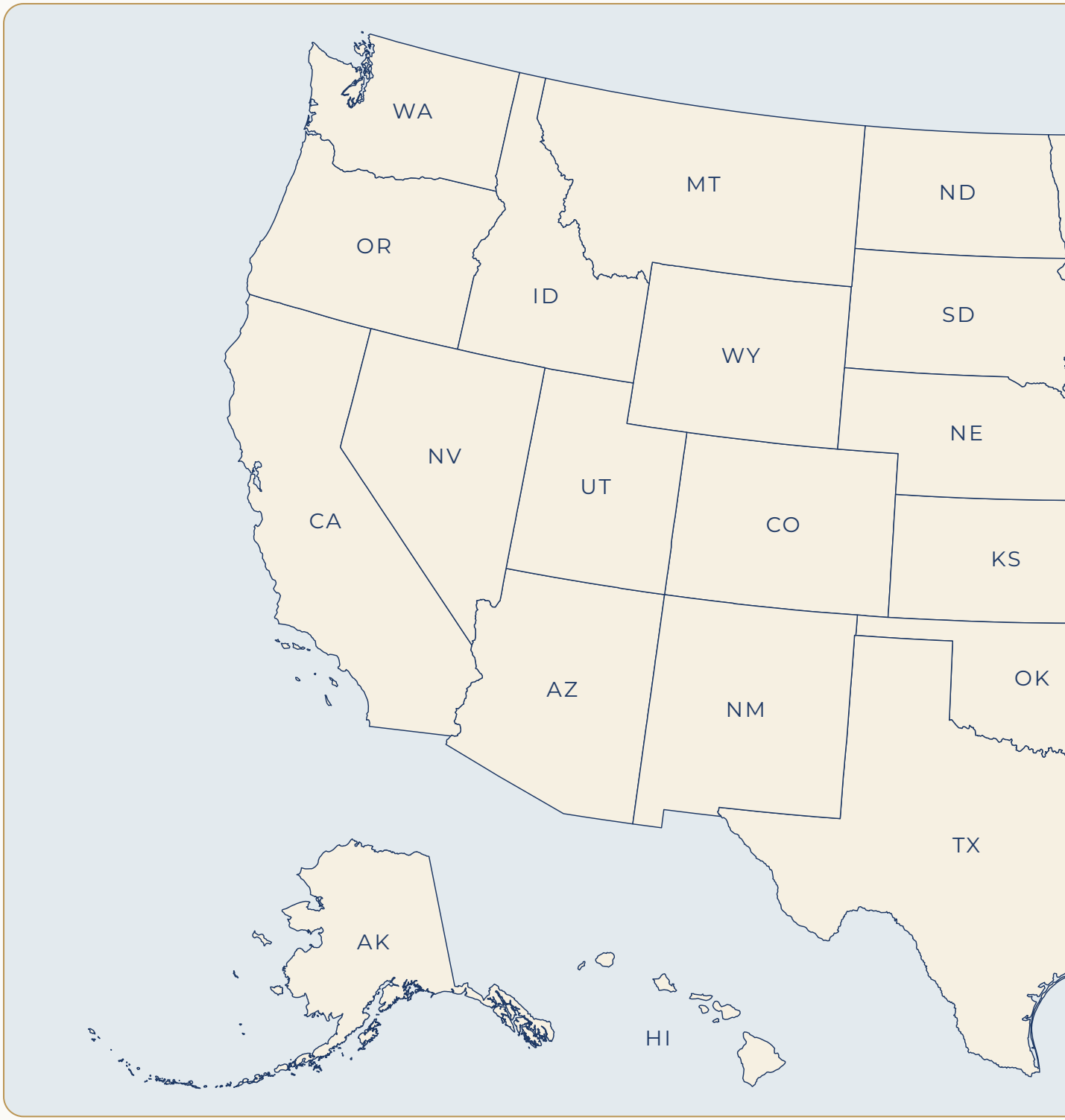
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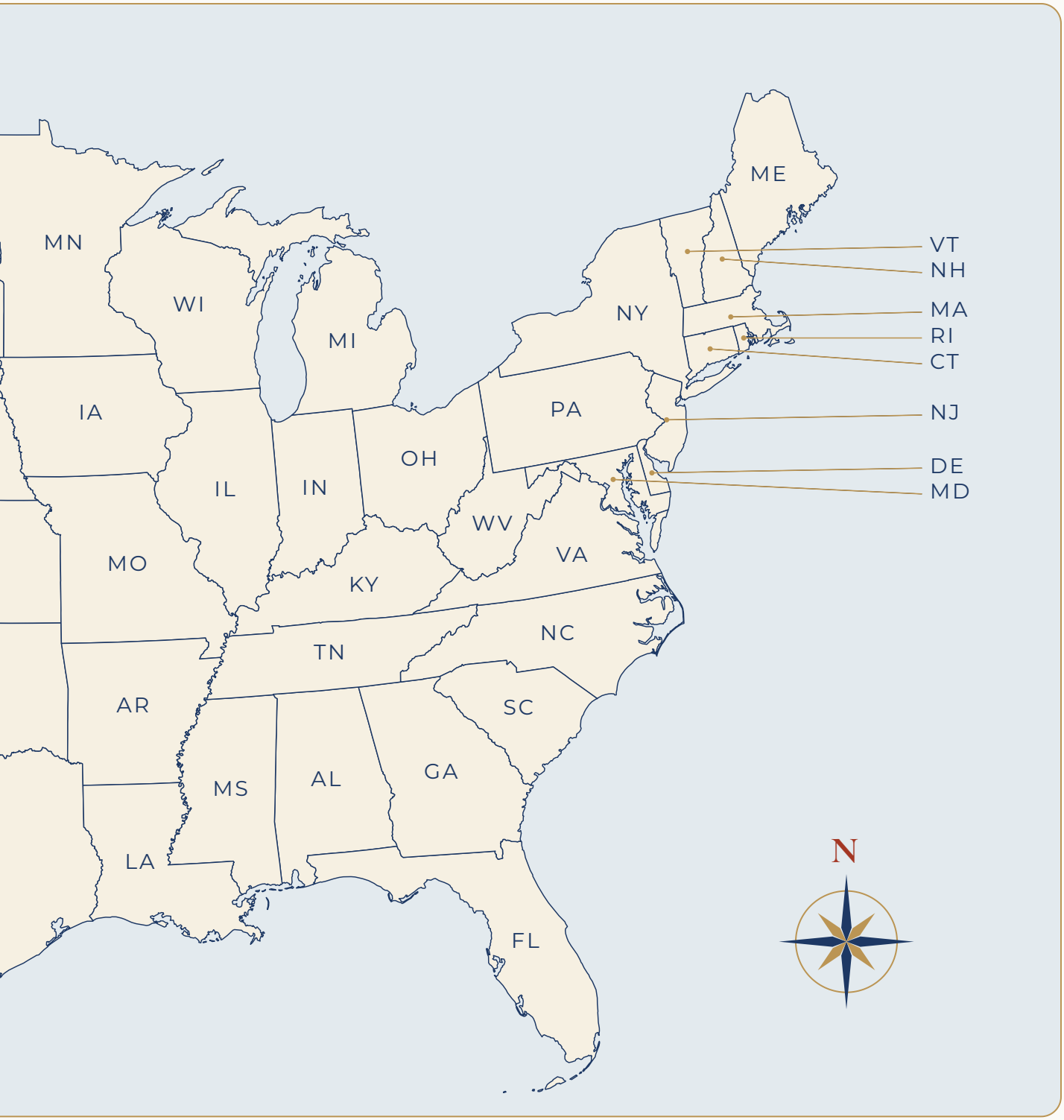



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CINCINNATI CHILI

A whisper of cinnamon and chocolate turns humble meat sauce into a layered obsession—one that makes grown Ohioans weep with homesickness.

Yield: 4–6 servings

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb. ground beef (80% lean)
- 4 cups water
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 Tbsp chili powder
- 1 Tbsp granulated garlic (sub: 2 Tbsp fresh garlic, minced)
- 1 Tbsp onion powder (sub: one sweet onion, minced)
- 1 Tbsp sweet paprika
- 1½ tsp salt, plus more to taste
- ½ tsp ground allspice
- ½ tsp ground black pepper
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ½ tsp ground cloves
- ½ tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp oregano
- ¼ tsp cayenne pepper (adjust to taste)
- ½ tsp cocoa
- ⅓ cup tomato paste
- 1 Tbsp red wine vinegar (sub: 1 Tbsp apple cider vinegar)
- 1 Tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 8 oz. spaghetti noodles
- 1 cup shredded cheddar cheese (optional)
- 2 cups cooked kidney beans (optional)
- ½ cup diced sweet onions (optional)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. *Make the slurry*: Add ground beef and water to a large pot and mix until it forms a slurry mix. Break up the ground beef with a whisk or potato masher. You want the beef broken up into bits.
2. *Season*: Add the bay leaf, all spices, cocoa, tomato paste, red wine vinegar, and Worcestershire sauce to the ground beef slurry and mix well.
3. *Simmer*: Heat the slurry mix on high until boiling. Once boiling, reduce heat to a simmer, uncovered, for 2–3 hours.
4. *Cook the noodles*: Once the chili is almost done, prepare the noodles according to package instructions.
5. *Serve*: Choose your style, a 2-way, 5-way or any way in between!

NOTES & TIPS

- 2-Way: Noodles; Chili
- 3-Way: Noodles; Chili; Shredded Cheddar
- 4-Way: Noodles; Chili; Shredded Cheddar; Kidney Beans
- 5-Way: Noodles; Chili; Shredded Cheddar; Kidney Beans; Sweet Onions

TIME-SAVER TIP

- You can use an Instant Pot to save time. Simply reduce the water to 3 cups, mix all ingredients in the Instant Pot, select Pressure and cook on High pressure for 30 minutes.



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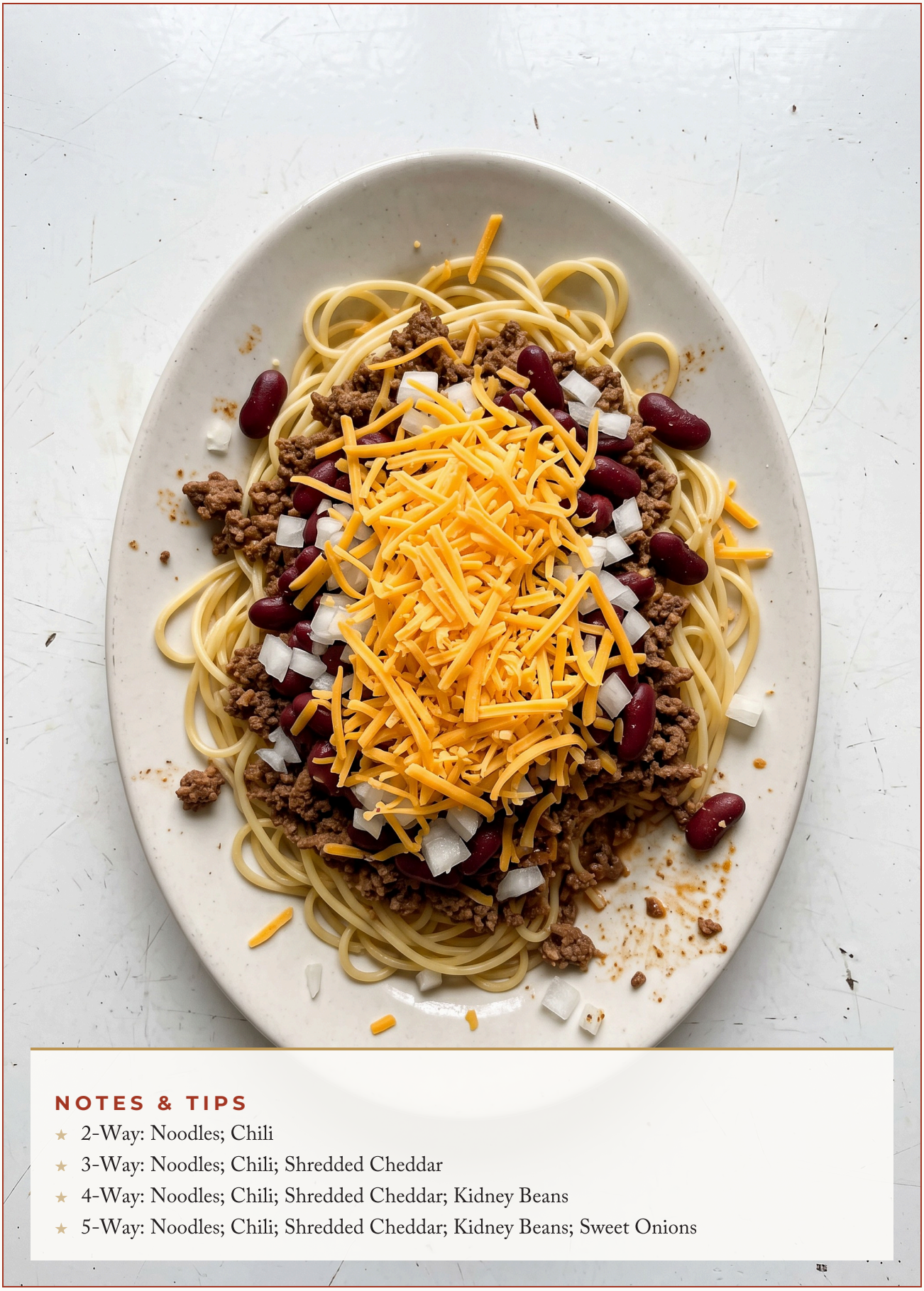
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